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HTC HD7

Sleek and stylish, but far from perfect

Beautiful looking phone – black and dark grey, exceedingly slim side bezels, and a massive 4.3-inch capacitive touchscreen. It has a raised metal bezel running around the phone, which means that placing the phone face down on a flat surface will not scratch the display.

There are three touch-sensitive keys beneath the glass slab that extend below the LCD. These are well spaced and quite usable. The camera key offers no feedback to half-click (for autofocus). The Micro USB port and 3.5mm jack are conveniently located on the bottom of the phone. The touchscreen is sensitive, and navigating around is a snap.

The display is mediocre – colour and contrast are strictly so-so. The camera on the HD7 is pretty decent with colour and contrast, and the flash is reasonably powerful. Music quality via the handsfree kit is good – decent bass for earphones, and a nice mid-range. The loudspeaker is frankly rubbish for music and distorts a lot. Video playback is a mediocre experience. While the large display is good, colours can look a bit washed out, and the contrast is mediocre at best. Battery life seems decent considering the paltry 1230 mAh powerplant.



With heavy usage and 2-3 hours of calls, battery life drops to 25 per cent within a day.

With good reception, call quality and clarity is good, but as signal levels drop slightly, there is a loss of coherence on the other end. At an MRP of 29,990, the HD7 isn't cheap. Neither is it close to perfect. There are better performing, more rounded devices available.

Michael Browne

Specifications

OS: Windows Phone 7;
CPU: Qualcomm QSD8250 (1 GHz); RAM: 576 MB;
Display: 4.3-inch, 480x800 pixels, capacitive; battery: 1230 mAh; weight: 162 grams

Contact

Bright Point India

Phone: 9910821100

Email: nitin.pandita@brightpoint.com

Website: www.htc.com/in

Price: ₹29,990 (MOP)

7.0
10

Features	7.5
Performance	7.0
Build Quality	7.0
Value for money	5.5

Specifications

Video formats : MP4, MOV, AVI, MKV, FLV;
Audio formats : MP3, WAV, OGG, AAC, FLAC;
Connectivity : HDMI, SD card slot, USB

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: 91 22 6166 8800

Email: reachus@asus.com

Website: www.asus.in

Price: ₹4,400

7.0
10

Features	6.5
Performance	7.0
Build Quality	7.0
Value for money	7.5

ASUS O! Play Mini

Finally, an affordable HD media player

HD media players have been flooding the market since the last year, but most of the better ones start from ₹5,000 and up. With the ASUS O! Play Mini, that barrier has been lowered. Asus O! Play Mini is a basic HD media player supporting resolutions upto 1080p. It has an SD card slot and a USB port in the front. It is one of those rare HD media players that bundles in an HDMI cable. We really don't know what stops companies from bundling an HDMI cables with the HD media players.

It is a compact player with a sturdy build. The patterned design on top with recessed

ports makes the player look aesthetically pleasing.

HD media playback was quite smooth and we did not notice any video skipping. HD movies – both 720p and 1080p played quite well. Fast forwarding proved to be an issue as the maximum speed is 32x and does not allow seeking. Starting up the player took around 14 seconds whereas movie loading took under 5 seconds. User interface is quite straight forward but we found that it does take some time to segregate the media according to its type, depending on your hard drive



capacity. It is faster to use the file manager to get to your file. Options like resume playback are quite good. It also allows you to upgrade the firmware from a USB drive.

At ₹4,400, O! Play Mini is a very economical full HD media player around that can play literally anything you throw at it. We will definitely recommend this, for those who are looking at a no frills HD media player.

Nimish Sawant